

Outlook

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Which card declines become complaints?

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

The same decline code can lead to a successful retry, an ATM attempt, a phone call or lost activity. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

Could the answer be that poor explanations drive complaints more than the decline itself? Or are we actually seeing that repeat declines cluster by card state or channel? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that most declines recover immediately.

We looked at a version of this before. For the July 2020 review, please show what changed and whether the earlier conclusion still holds. The practical decision is which decline reasons need rule, message or service changes. Please send a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. The data does not contain merchant terminal logs or card-scheme dispute outcomes.

Regards